

CMF Buds Pro 2

Great TWS under ₹5,000... Almost

Nothing has outdone itself again with the CMF Buds Pro 2. In a market that, as a simple internet search will show you, is saturated with offerings in the TWS space across budgets, and even more in the sub-₹5,000 segment, you have the problem of plenty when you are out in the market looking for a pair of TWS in-ear earphones. Manufacturers across the board make lofty promises which they often fail to fulfil. However, in this sea of confusion, once in a while, you get products like the CMF Buds Pro 2, which make the process of making a decision clear as a crystal ball.

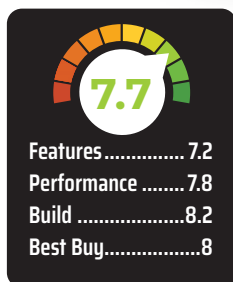
Having read this, you might have a fair idea of how these TWS in-ear earphones fared in my testing, so without spilling a lot beans, I will dive into my review of the CMF Buds Pro 2 –

BUILD AND DESIGN

The CMF Buds Pro 2 retain the quintessential Nothing form factor, which we saw in the CMF Buds that were launched earlier in the year. There are subtle differences in the design, but the case size and the buds' design remain more or less the same, showing the CMF Buds Pro 2's Nothing lineage. The biggest noticeable difference here is – the crown finally has functionality. More on that later.

Coming back to the design of the case and the buds, the branding on the case is printed on the screen instead of being moulded into the front. Still no metallic hinge, but the metal has been repurposed into the dial, which adds a ton of functionality. When you open the case, you find regulatory information printed on the inside of the lid and the CMF by Nothing branding in the area where the earbuds fit. On the stem of the buds, you will see the CMF iconography, which is about it. The colour scheme is monochromatic, and there is not much to talk about. The fit of

₹4,298



the buds is more or less the same as the other Nothing products, and if the Nothing Ear fits you well, or if you were one of those who bought the Nothing Ear (1), then you will not have much to complain about here.

The build quality of the buds is solid and better than most other buds at this price. The case has a nice heft to it, the buds are sturdy yet lightweight, and the magnets holding the lid and the buds in place are plenty strong. There is not much to complain about here, apart from the fact that there is no metallic hinge. Metallic hinges provide a nice sturdiness to the case and, in the long term, add durability to it. Nothing takes the victory home with the build and design of the CMF Buds Pro 2.

FEATURES

In terms of the features, the CMF Buds Pro 2 are packed to the brim. The biggest highlight here is the smart control dial, which comes from the CMF Buds and has been brought to life by the brand. You can access the controls from the dial itself which are a plenty.

There are five different dial actions – rotate, single-click, double-click, triple-click, and long-press – which you can configure for any of the above-listed actions from the Nothing X app. You can also turn the Smart Dial on and off by double pressing and holding the dial. In my time of use, I did not encounter any hitches using the dial, and its responsiveness was on point.

Coming to the other features, you get the regular suite that you would expect from a pair of TWS in-ear earphones that are priced at around ₹5,000. You have ANC (more on this later), Spatial Audio effect dual connection between devices, ChatGPT integration, and the best of them all, Dirac Opteo EQ preset, which you can enable in the Nothing X app. What Dirac Opteo does, is that it tunes the audio to match the levels of different frequencies to match that of the original mastering of the track, while compensating for the limitations of the drivers of the buds, to ensure that you are listening to the track, as the artist intended. This feature knocks it out of the park, and for the purists, will be an instant selling point.

When you are in the Nothing X app, there are tons of other customisations that you can access to make the buds truly your own, and ChatGPT integration. The app interface is also on point, and the navigation is intuitive. You will have no issues when trying to tinker with the settings of the CMF Buds Pro 2.

PERFORMANCE

In terms of the performance of the CMF Buds Pro 2, you get about as much as you would expect from a pair of TWS in-ear earphones around the ₹5,000 mark. Let's get started with the sound signature of the CMF Buds Pro 2.

With these earbuds, you have a dual-driver design consisting of an 11mm bass driver and a 6mm micro-planar tweeter. When working with a dual-driver setup, the brands have to be careful about frequency roll-off, which means that the frequencies produced by one driver overwhelm the others. In this case, the tuning by Nothing, ensures that out of the box, the bass produced by the 11mm driver